Investigation Report: Global Migration and the Experience of an OFW

I. Profile of the Interviewee

For this investigation, I interviewed a 24-year-old Overseas Filipino Worker whom I have known online for around three years. We originally met while playing Valorant and eventually became friends and stayed in contact. Since he currently works abroad, I chose to interview him because I wanted to understand the experience of an OFW from someone I personally know.

For his privacy, I will not include his full name. He graduated from De La Salle University and pursued a career in Information Technology, particularly cybersecurity. Around a year after graduating, he moved to Saudi Arabia to pursue career opportunities in his field. He currently lives and works there while his family remains in the Philippines.

II. Summary of the Interview

During our conversation, we discussed his decision to move abroad and what it was like to begin his professional career in another country. What stood out to me was how young he was when he became an OFW. He had only been out of college for around a year, meaning he had to adjust to professional life and another country almost at the same time.

One of his main motivations was the opportunity to develop his career in IT and cybersecurity. Working in Saudi Arabia allowed him to gain professional experience and become more independent. Since cybersecurity continues to become important as organizations depend more on technology, working overseas also provided a different environment where he could develop his skills.

However, moving abroad also came with challenges. He had to adjust to a different culture, lifestyle, workplace, and daily routine. Being separated from family and friends was another major adjustment. Although video calls and messages make communication easier, they cannot completely replace being physically present.

Despite these difficulties, working overseas has provided opportunities for personal and professional growth. He has gained experience in his chosen field while becoming more independent and adaptable. For him, working abroad continues to be worth pursuing because of the experience and career opportunities it provides.

III. Critical Evaluation

The interview showed me how globalization affects people personally. Globalization allows technology, businesses, information, and workers to operate across national borders. My friend's experience demonstrates this because the education and skills he gained in the Philippines are now being used in Saudi Arabia. Filipino professionals can therefore participate directly in the international labor market.

His experience can also be connected to the push and pull factors of migration. Push factors encourage people to leave their home country, while pull factors attract them toward another country. In his situation, career development and professional opportunities in Saudi Arabia were important pull factors. His experience shows that migration is not always caused only by financial difficulties. Professional growth can also influence someone's decision to work overseas.

Migration remains important to Philippine society. According to the Philippine Statistics Authority (2025), approximately 2.19 million Filipinos worked overseas in 2024. The agency also estimated that OFWs sent around ₱262.20 billion in total remittances during the survey period. This demonstrates how overseas employment affects both Filipino households and the Philippine economy.

Migration has several positive effects. OFWs can gain income, professional experience, skills, and exposure to different working environments. However, these opportunities also involve challenges such as homesickness, cultural differences, family separation, and adapting to unfamiliar workplaces.

Government institutions also play an important role. The Department of Migrant Workers protects the rights and promotes the welfare of OFWs, while the Overseas Workers Welfare Administration provides programs for migrant workers and their families. OWWA provides reintegration support that includes financial literacy, psychosocial assistance,

skills training, and livelihood preparation. However, these services need to remain accessible to OFWs while they are abroad and when they eventually return to the Philippines.

IV. Personal Insights

Before this investigation, I mostly thought of OFWs as Filipinos who leave because they can earn more abroad. Talking to someone I personally know changed my perspective because I realized that migration can also be about professional growth and finding opportunities that match someone's career goals.

What stood out to me was that he moved abroad while still young. After studying in the Philippines, he had to begin another stage of his life in a completely different country. Becoming an OFW requires more than simply finding a job abroad because a person also needs to adjust emotionally, socially, and professionally.

I also developed a greater appreciation for the role of OFWs in Philippine development. Their remittances support Filipino families and contribute to the economy, but their contribution goes beyond money. They also gain skills, knowledge, and professional experience that can benefit their families and potentially the Philippines.

Overall, this investigation helped me understand migration from a more personal perspective. Globalization creates opportunities for Filipinos beyond the Philippines, but these opportunities can also require sacrifices. The experiences of OFWs show both the benefits and challenges of global migration.

V. Evidence of Authentic Investigation

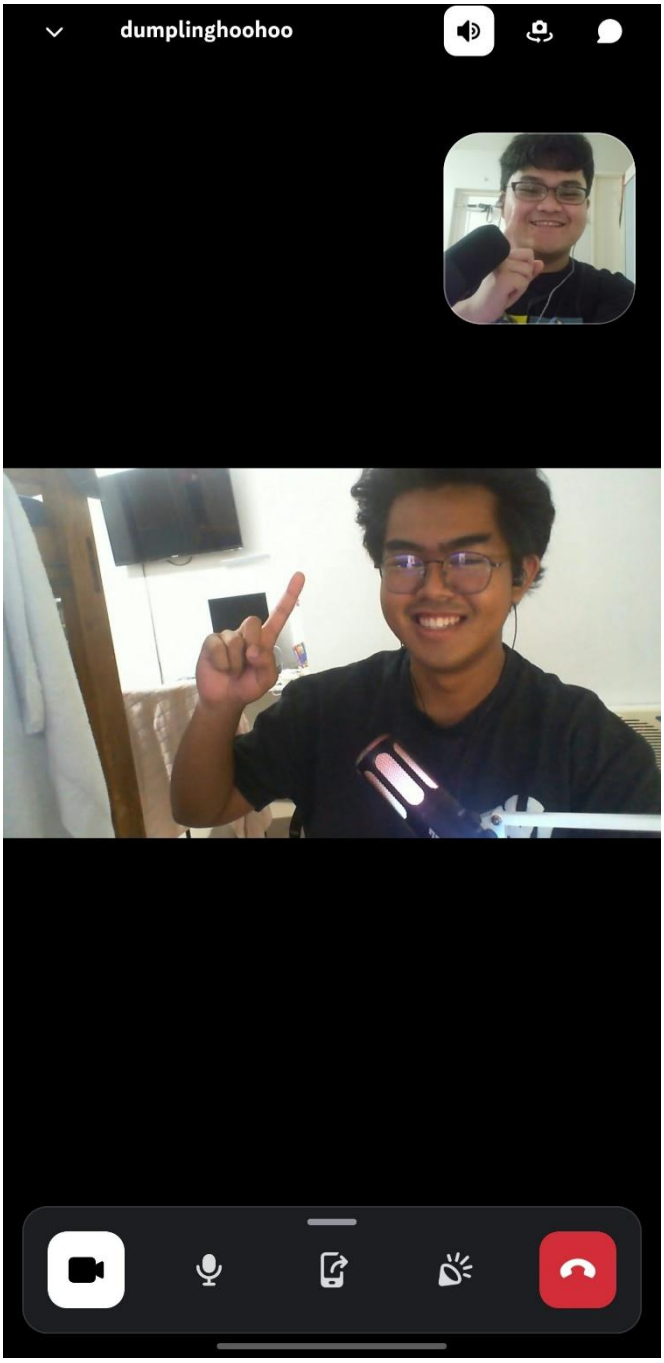


Figure 1. Online interview with the OFW interviewee conducted through a video call, with the interviewee's consent.

VI. AI Use Disclosure

AI Tool Used: ChatGPT by OpenAI

Prompts Used: I asked ChatGPT to organize my interview notes, improve grammar and clarity, and help connect my ideas to concepts about global migration.

How AI Assisted My Work: ChatGPT helped organize my report into the required sections and improve the clarity and grammar of my writing.

Verification of Accuracy: I reviewed the final report, compared the details with my interview information, and checked the factual information and references before submission.

References

Department of Migrant Workers. (n.d.). Mandate. https://ro7.dmw.gov.ph/mandate

Overseas Workers Welfare Administration. (n.d.). Reintegration. https://owwa.gov.ph/reintegration/

Philippine Statistics Authority. (2025, December 16). Results of the 2024 Overseas Filipino Workers: Number of Overseas Filipino Workers grew. https://psa.gov.ph/statistics/survey/labor-and-employment/survey-overseas-filipinos/node/1684081308